

Progettazione di Applicazioni Mobili

Mobile app design

Prototype – Part 1/2

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Prototyping

- In the context of software development, a prototype (from *proto*=first and *typos*=impression) is an initial version of a software system that is used to demonstrate concepts, try out design options and generally find out more about the problems and their possible solutions
- A prototype can be employed to explore whatever information is most relevant to the developer at a given stage

- The prototyping process should be done in cycles of iterative idea elaboration and reduction
 - Initial prototypes may explore extremely different concept designs at a very high and coarse level
 - The next stage may explore significant variations of these ideas
 - Further stages may try to clarify design issues where ideas are explored at finer granularities, until resolution
 - New radically different ideas may emerge at any time
- Each of the refinement cycles produces prototypes which are evaluated in user tests or expert evaluations
 - Only promising ideas are brought to the next stage

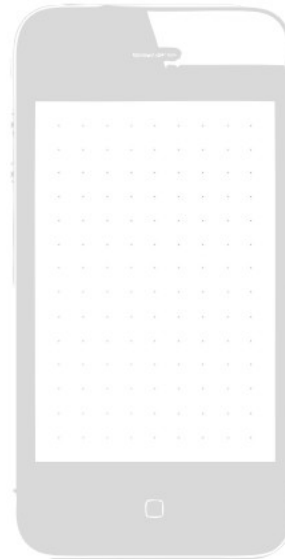
- In the approach we follow, the goal of prototyping is exploring different potential forms that the ultimate app design could take before spending resources in detailed designs and implementation
- The initial focus is creating low-fidelity prototypes for fast idea exploration.
- Subsequently, higher fidelity prototypes can be created to refine the design

- Typical prototyping activities, at different levels of fidelity:
 - Sketching
 - Wireframing
 - Hi-fi prototyping
- Additional activity in the prototyping process:
 - Task/user/interaction flows

Sketching

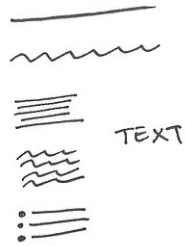
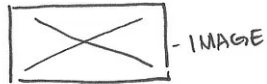
- Sketching is an important design tool because:
 - It can be used to quickly generate a range of potential design ideas (**getting the right design**)
 - This makes sketching an excellent tool for exploring constraints and trade-offs, and thinking through the implications of one design over another
 - If you discover that a certain idea won't work, you can quickly discard or revise the idea
 - It is a fast and inexpensive way to refine your ideas before transitioning to higher-fidelity mediums (**getting the design right**)
 - It is a natural deterrent to becoming too wedded to one particular idea too early
 - It is a powerful communication tool: if you share a sketch with others, they're more likely to give feedback on the core concepts rather than on surface aesthetics

- Typical material for sketching:
 - Pencil
 - Sticky notes (post-it) similar to a typical device screen in form size
 - Sketching template to support notes (keep the post-it separate for evaluation purposes)

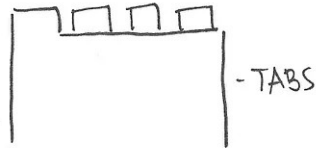


- Create your sketches based on the tasks that users will do with your app (as defined in the envision stage)
 - Focus on key tasks first
 - One common starting point is the home screen but not all tasks start from the home
 - Use common symbols/shapes for basic interface elements
- Keep in mind that users are likely moving, multi-tasking, distracted and interact with your interface with fingers, so keep the mobile experience simple and straightforward
 - This does not mean that interfaces should be empty/minimal

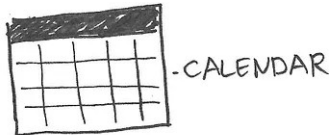
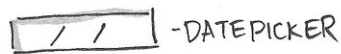
CONTENT:



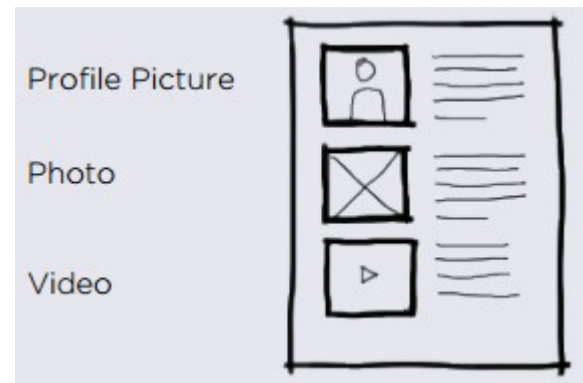
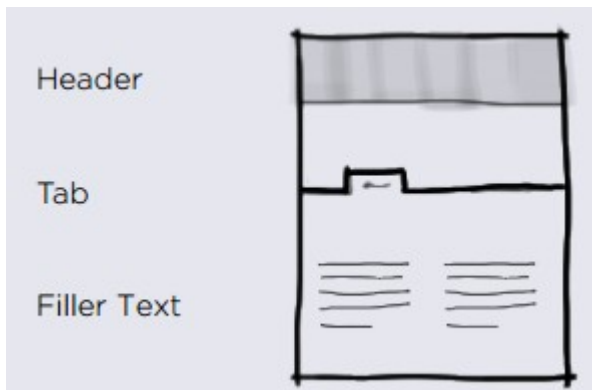
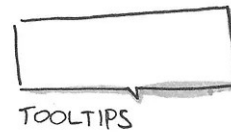
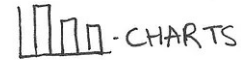
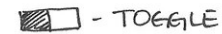
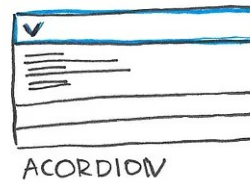
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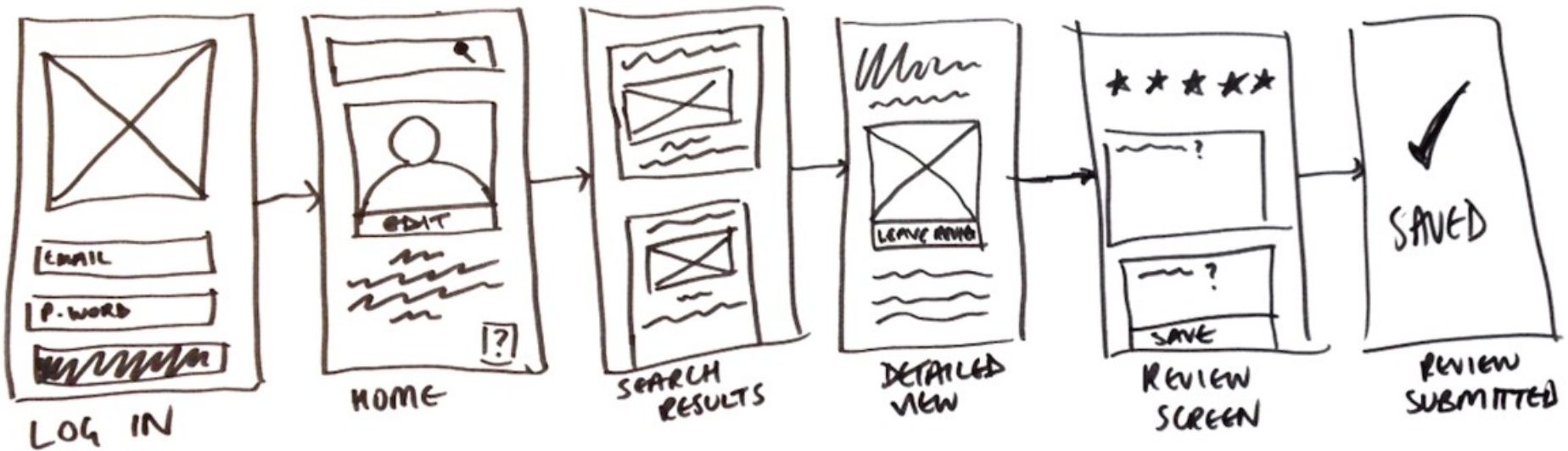
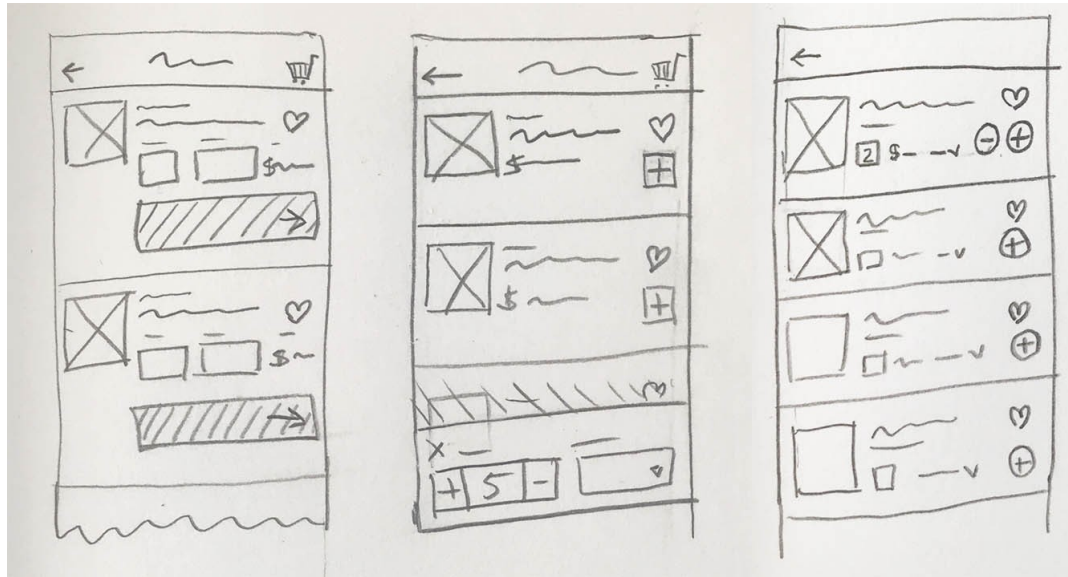


FORMS:



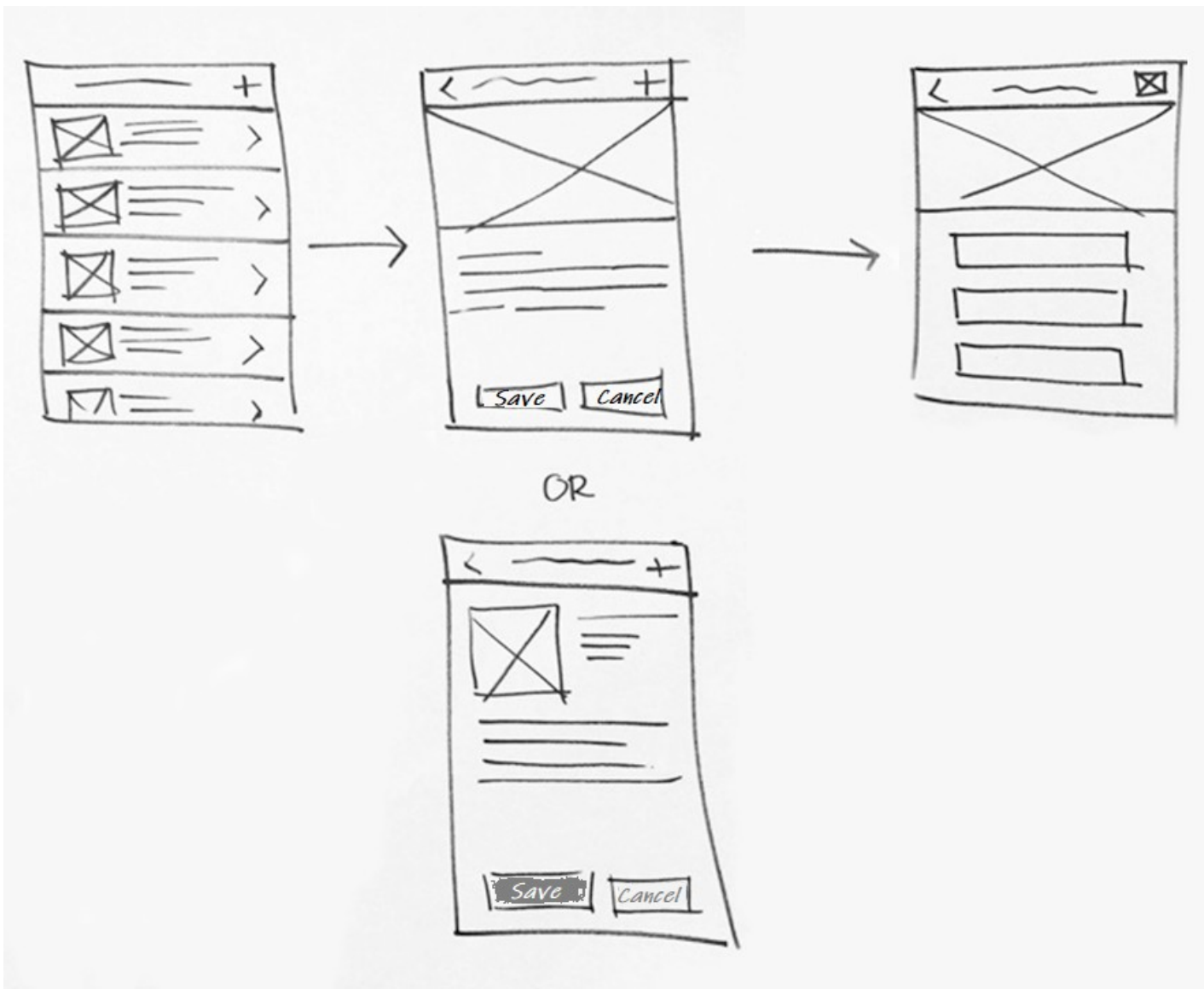
OTHER:

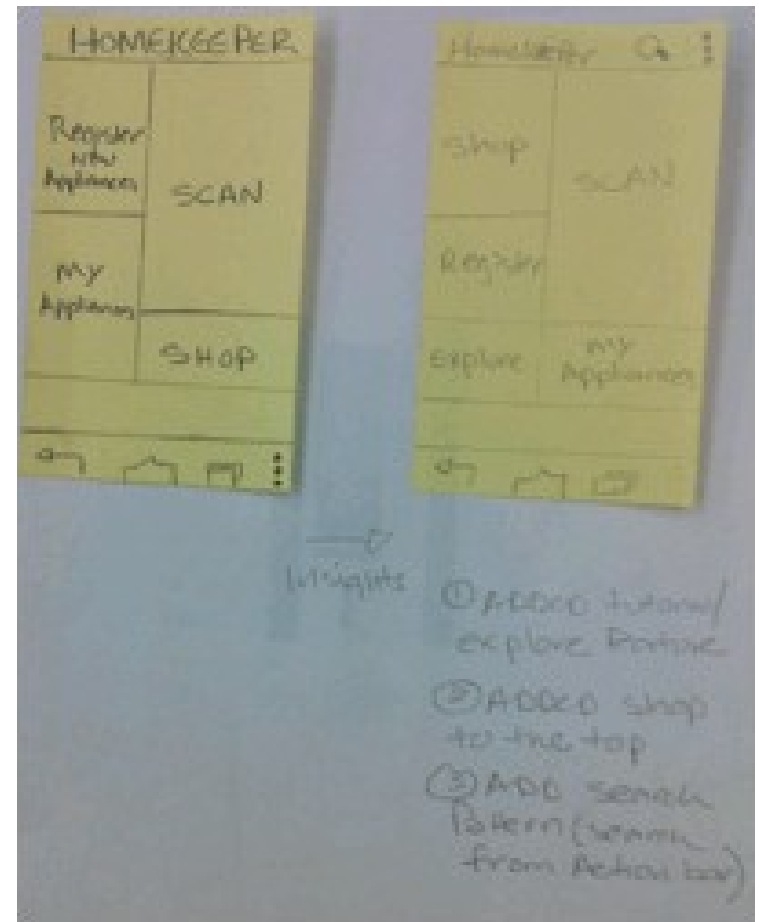




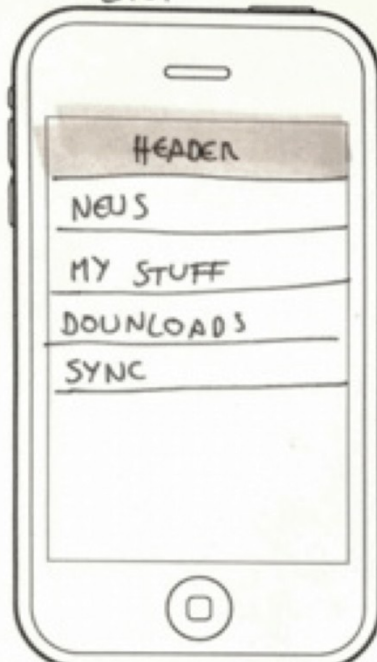
- **Explore alternative designs for app screens and screen sequences (based on tasks)**
- Try to force yourself to sketch at least a few additional ways you could design each part of the product
- This is useful for individual designers to bring the same kind of rigorous, exploratory, generative thinking that a team of designers brings to a design problem

- Alternative designs can involve:
 - Position, size and number of interface elements within one screen (getting the design right)
 - Different interface patterns (getting the right design/the design right)
 - Different ways to structure your app to support a task (getting the right design)





LIST



TABS

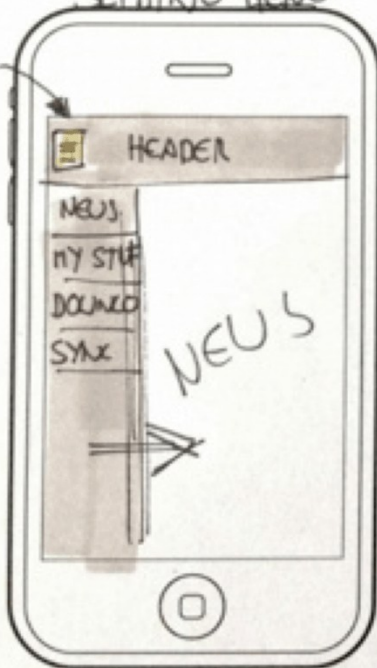


POPOVER

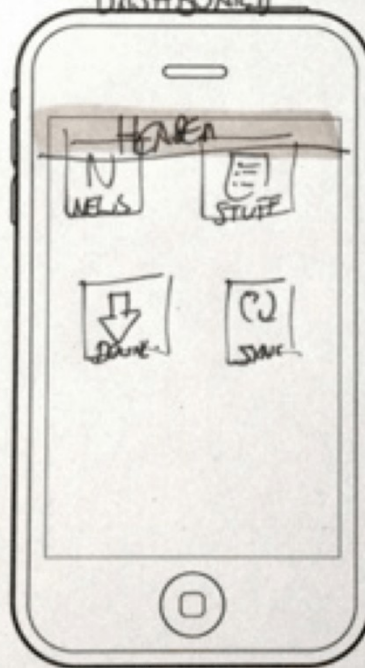


SLIDING MENU

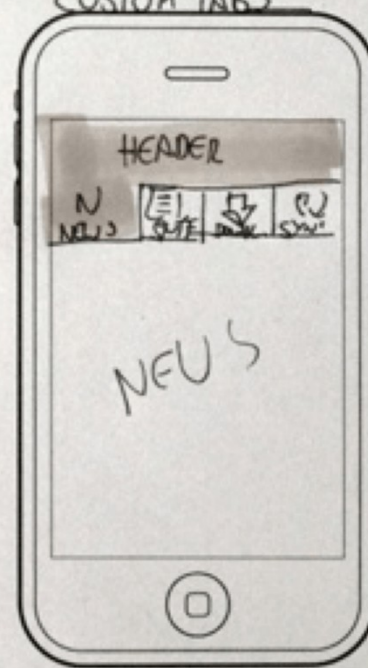
SLIDES
ON
CLICK



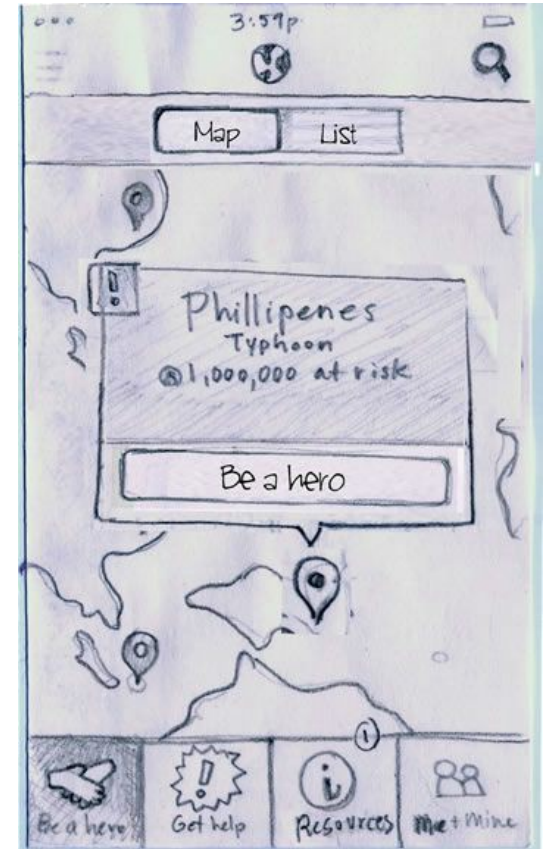
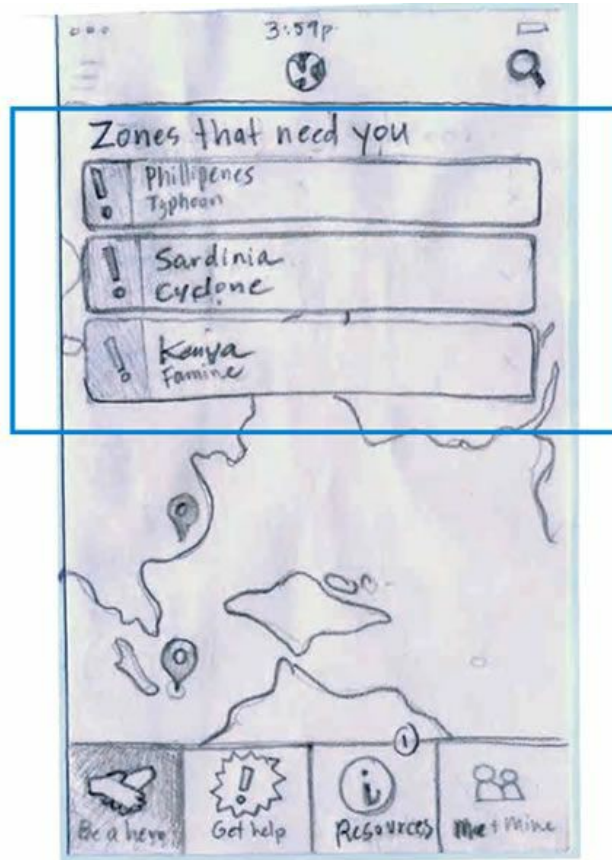
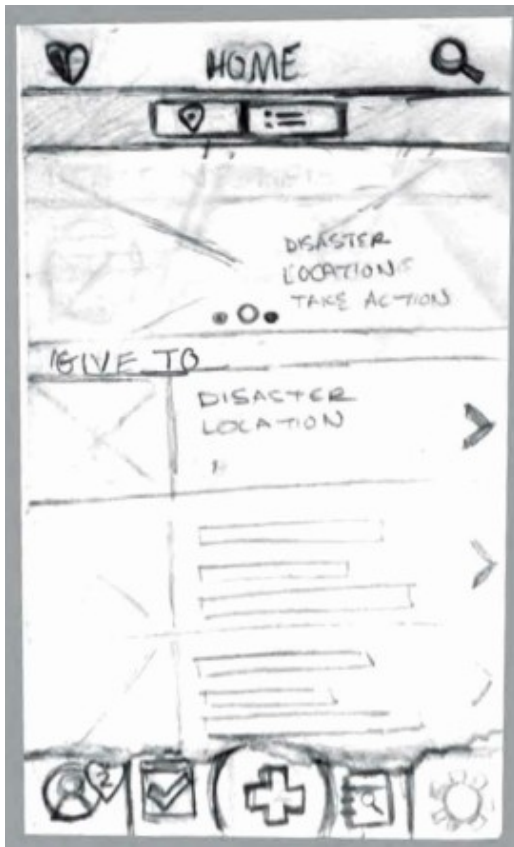
DASHBOARD

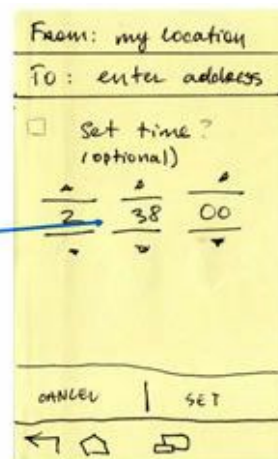
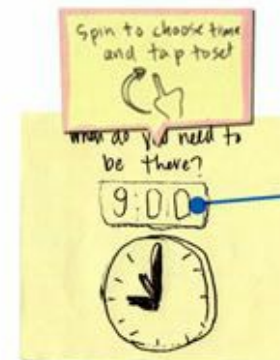
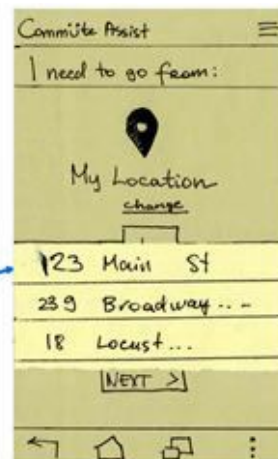
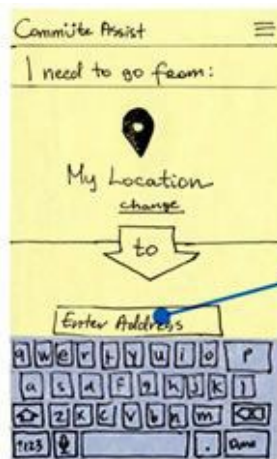
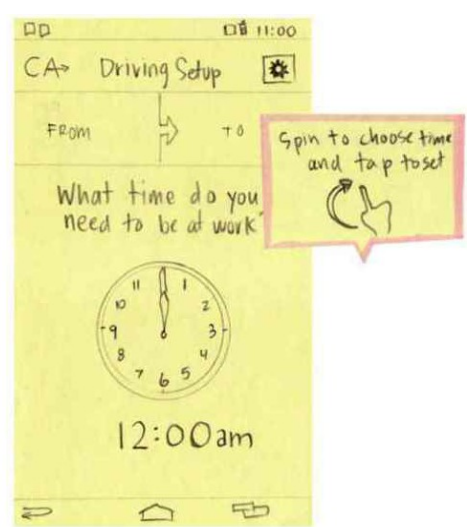
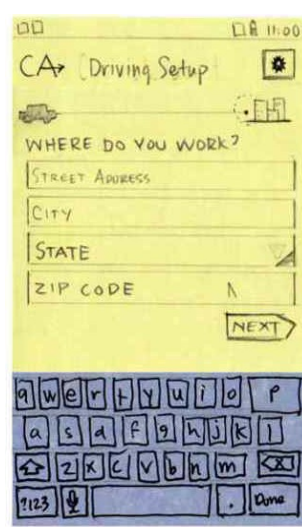
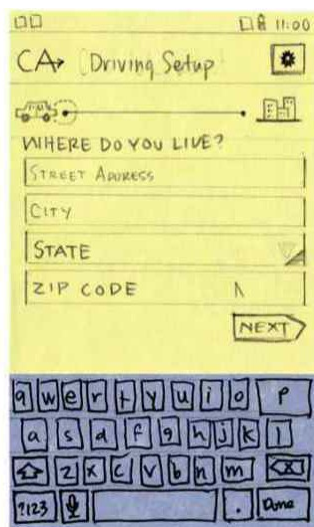
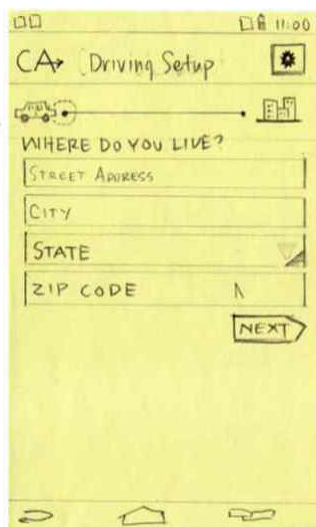
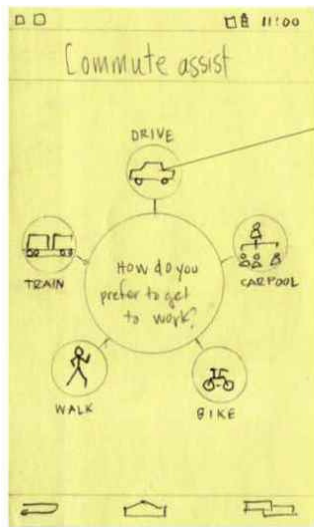


CUSTOM TABS



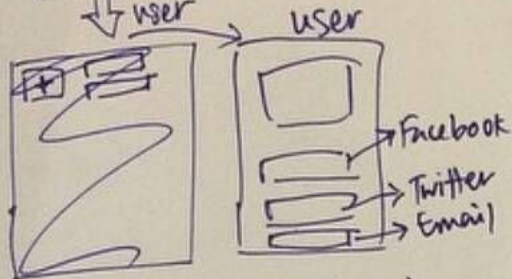
- Include key interface components in your sketches
- You can include placeholder content in initial sketches but use real content as you refine the prototype
- Do not reinvent the wheel
 - use existing interaction design patterns for mobile applications
 - follow the specific human-interface guidelines of each platform
 - draw inspiration from existing apps



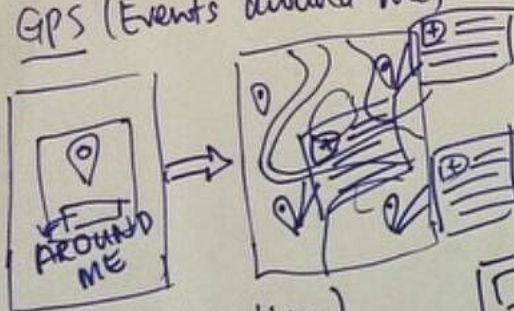


- When sketching, aesthetics are low priority
- You do, however, want to try to make sketches that someone else (or yourself after a few months) could look at and possibly make sense of
- To make your sketches clear, add annotations. Often, a short note and an arrow pointing to some part of the sketch are all it takes to clarify a sketch

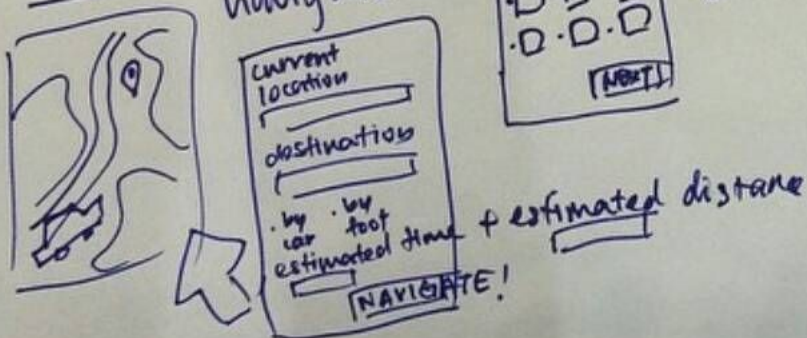
sign up



GPS (Events around me)



GPS (direction) navigate



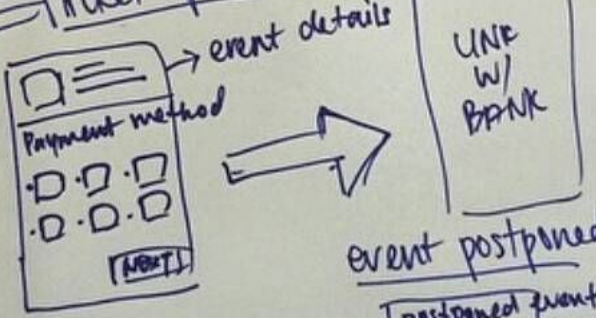
Notification



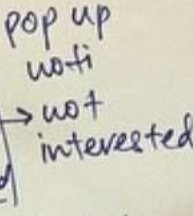
Quota full



Online Ticket purchase



event postponed



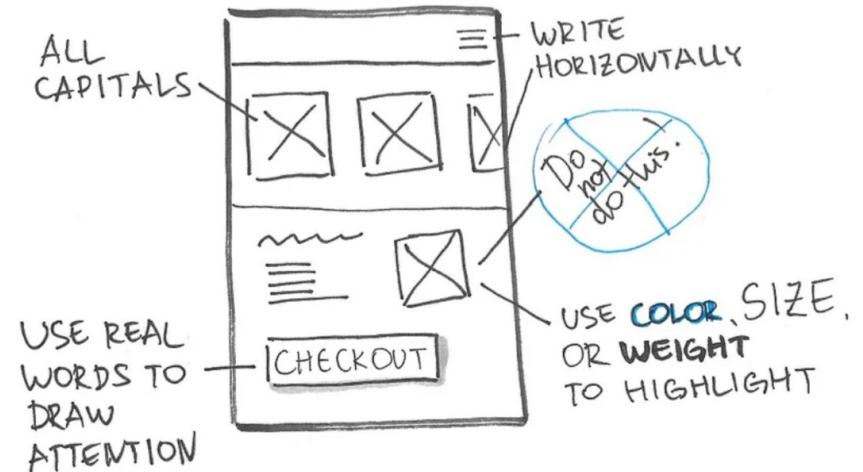
Remind



Calendar

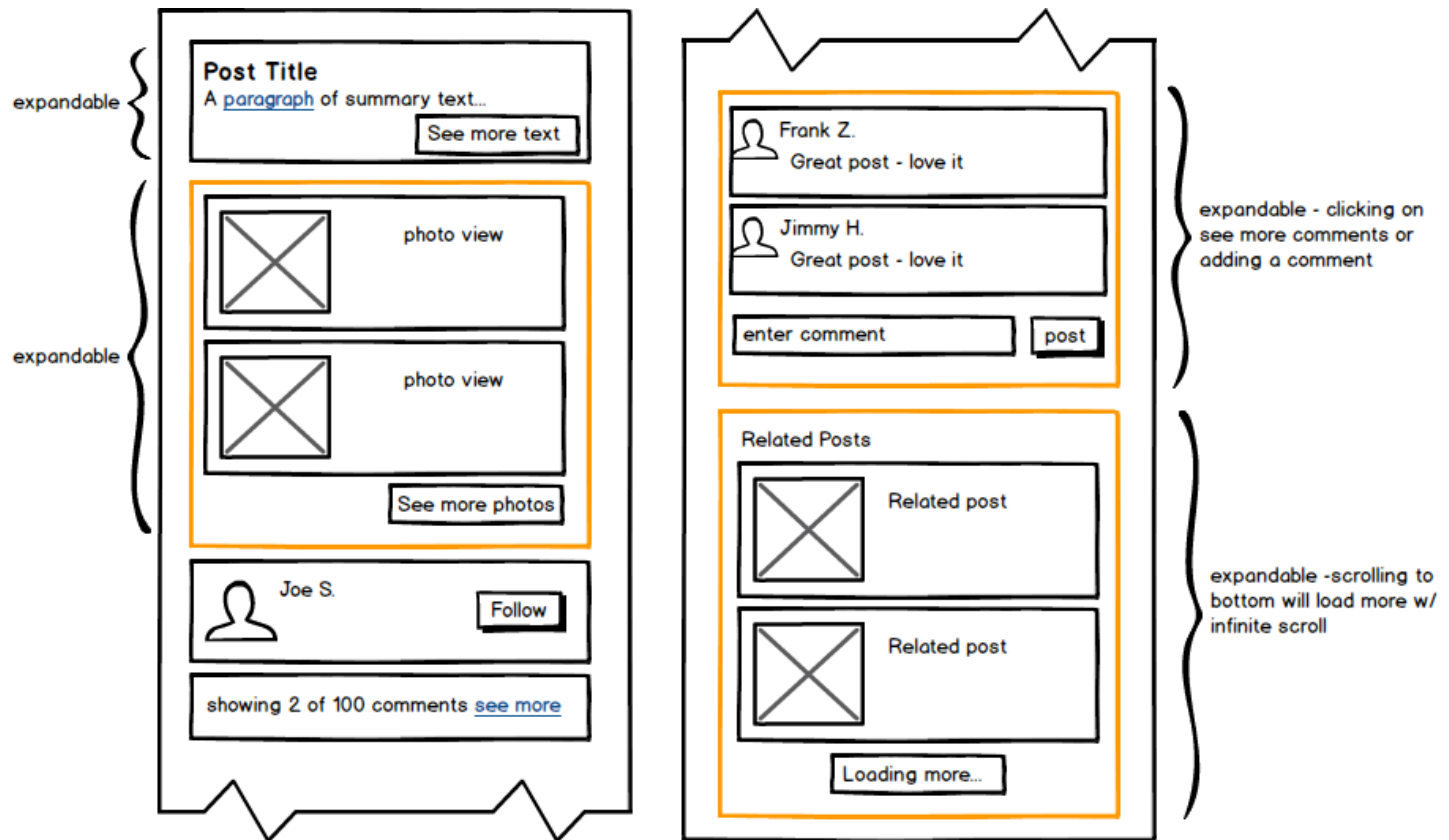


- Use all capital letters if your handwriting isn't the best
- Only write annotations horizontally
- Increase weight or size to highlight text, or use color if you have it
- Use the real text inside UI when you need to draw attention to it
- Use the language of the people you're going to be presenting your sketches to



Wireframing

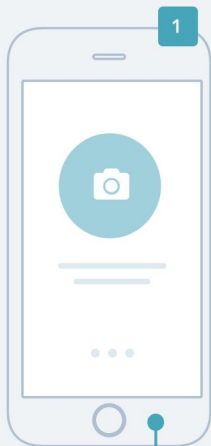
- A **wireframe** is typically a detailed black-and-white schematic of a screen



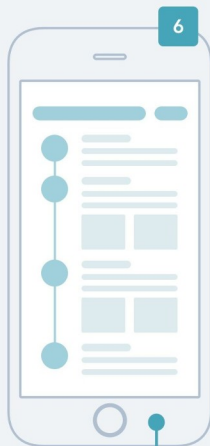
- Wireframes are focused on the core structure of screens:
 - What elements (widgets, information) should appear?
 - How should such elements be laid out?
 - How can someone move from one part of the product to another?
- You can start by converting the sketches you created before but you need to create wireframes for all the screens of your app
 - your wireframes don't have to be a perfect copy of your sketches
 - it's likely that you'll go into more detail, and think more about subtle nuances of the design

- You can create wireframes at different levels of details
 - start with the layout/structure of your screens; think about the size of each element with respect to the other elements
 - add details such as titles, labels, (possibly real) textual content, icons
 - do not focus on aesthetic aspects such as fonts and colors
- Wireframes usually include notes or annotations about how the product should behave
 - What should happen when you press on a particular button? How should interactive elements change, given certain conditions?
 - Notes make wireframes an interesting bridge between a design document and technical specifications

1. Onboarding



6. Notifications



7. Search



8.0. Itinerary



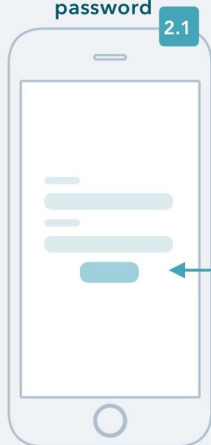
8.1. Create a trip



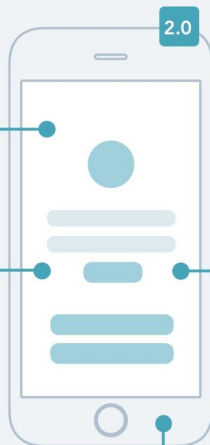
9. Timeline



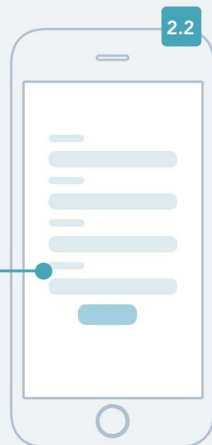
2.1. Forgotten password



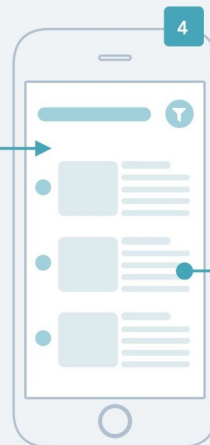
2.0. Sign-in



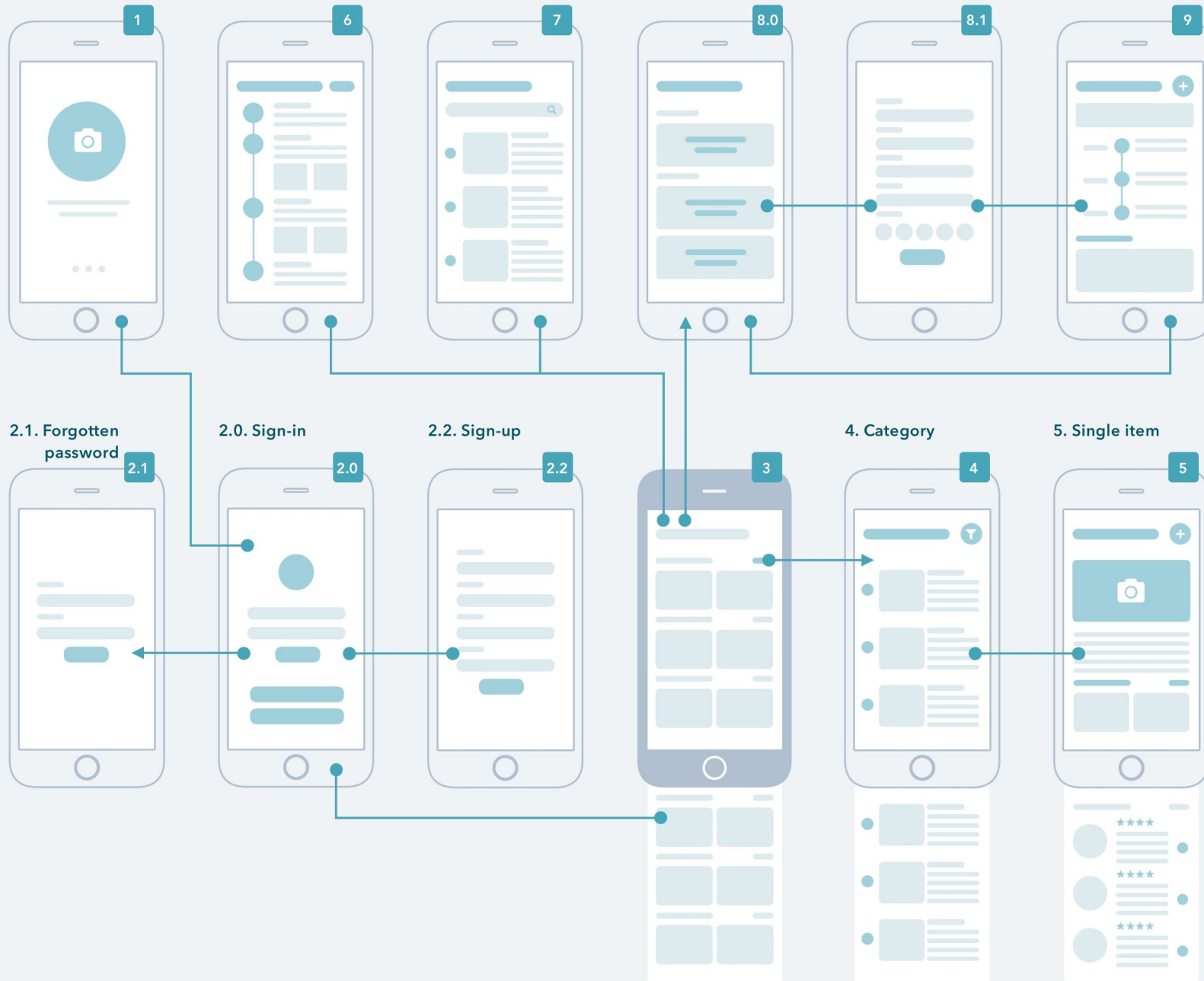
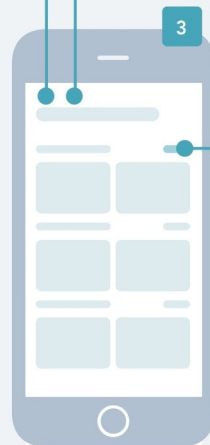
2.2. Sign-up

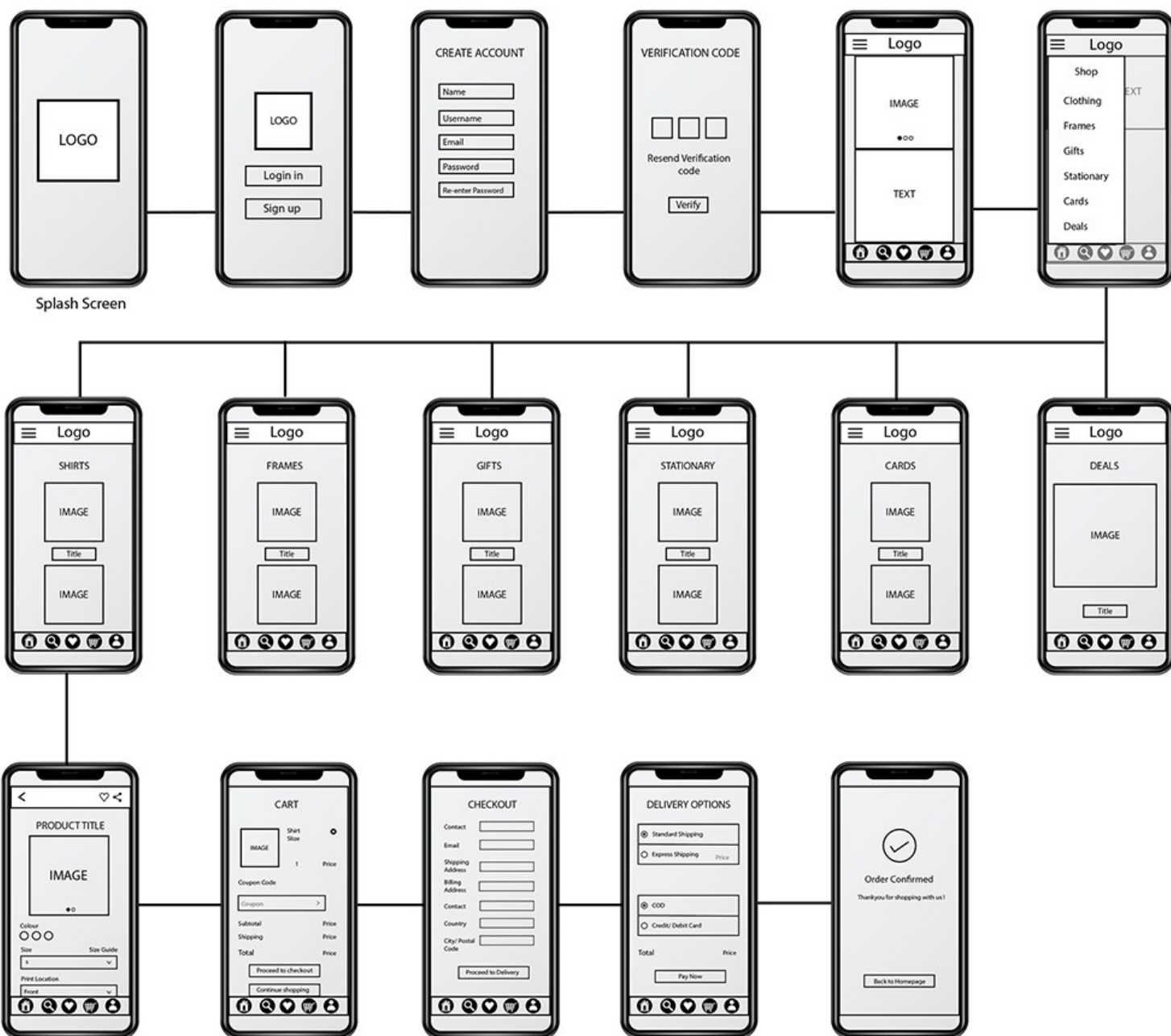


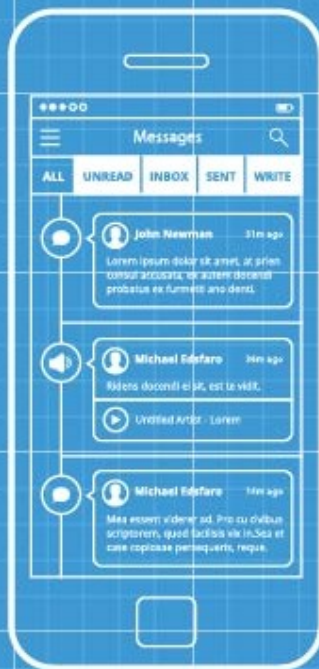
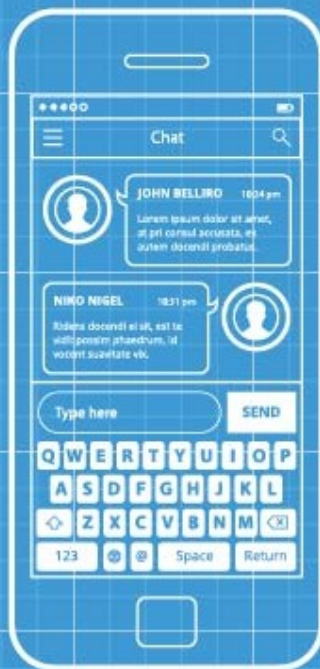
4. Category



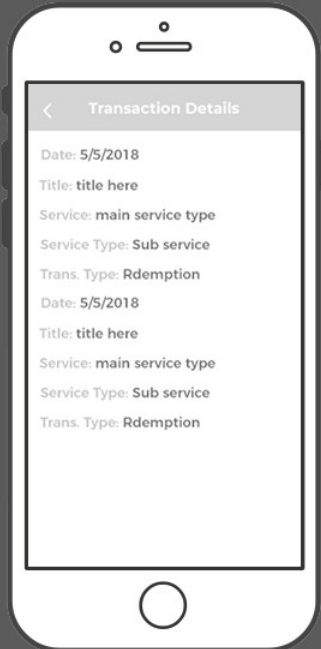
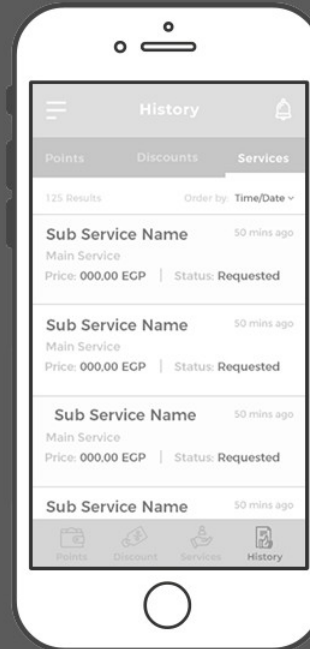
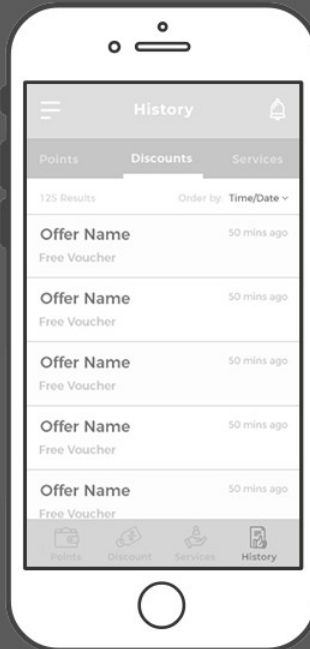
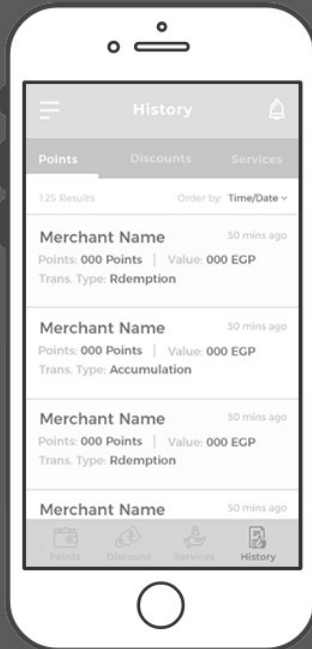
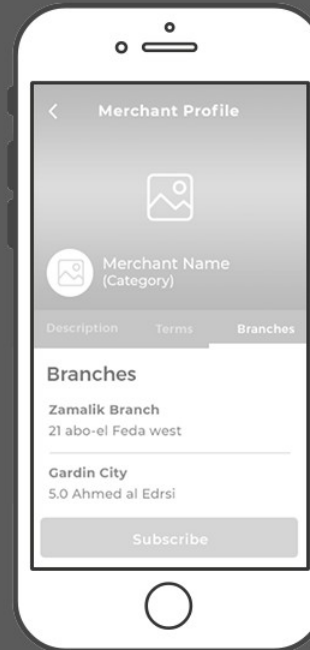
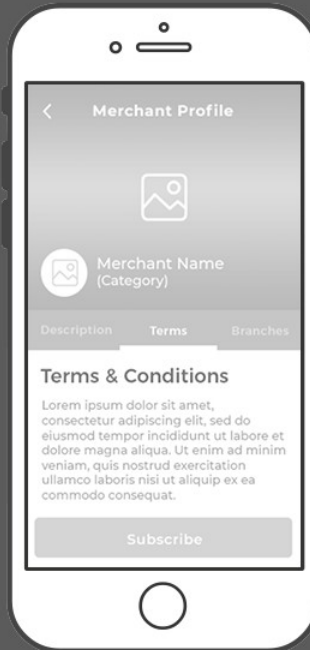
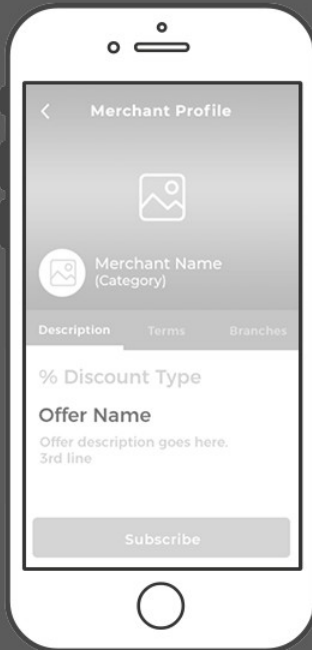
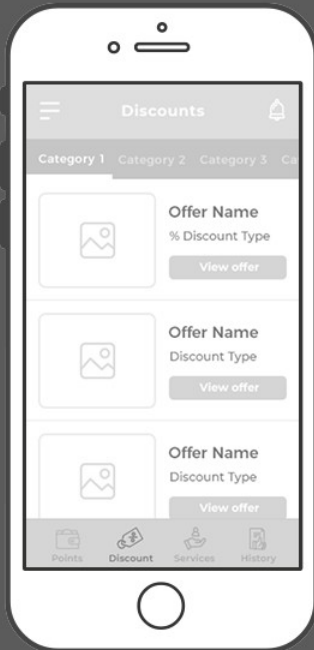
5. Single item

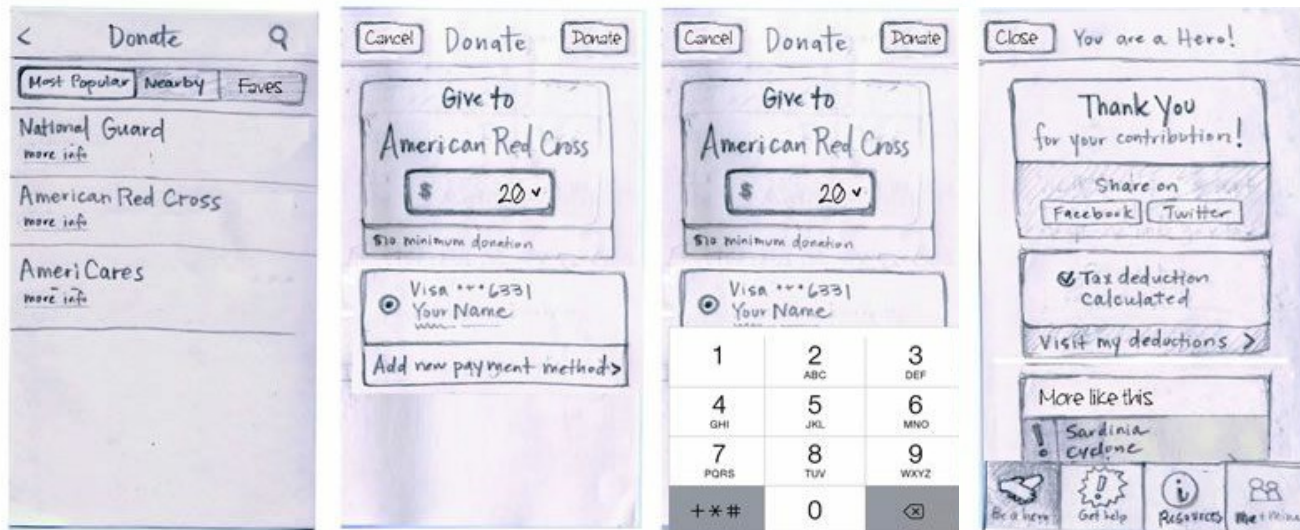






Mobile App Interface Wireframes







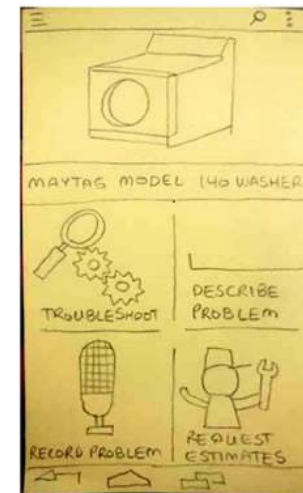
Repair item path



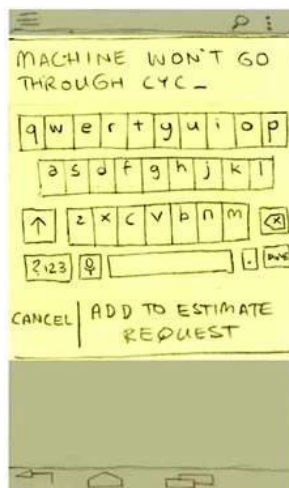
Repair exiting item



Select existing item



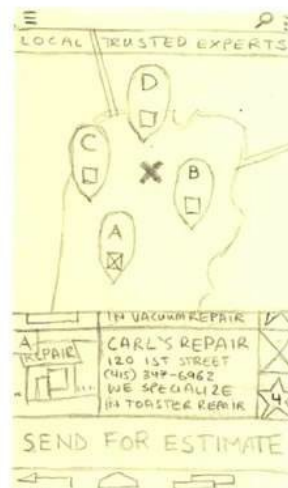
Item Record



Describe the problem



No results;



Find Local Repair Service



Rate Repair Service Reminder
Pops up the next time you open app

